

Dr Ananthan Ambikairajah

Neuroscientist. Educator. Science Communicator.

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CAREER OBJECTIVE AND MISSION STATEMENT

My career objective is to work in intellectually challenging environments that exercise my passions for research, teaching, science communication and governance. I aim to contribute to higher education in ways that support and inspire lifelong learning, foster critical thinking, advance knowledge and strengthen access to it. I am determined and committed to:

1. Conduct high quality research investigating genetic, environmental and lifestyle factors which influence ageing, brain health and disease, with a particular focus on dementia risk prediction and reduction as well as improving timely and accurate diagnosis.
2. Enhance student motivation and engagement to promote positive learning experiences and outcomes which foster a love of learning and facilitates a journey of personal growth and self-discovery.
3. Communicate science in an accessible, understandable and interesting way to spark public engagement, foster critical thinking and encourage respectful discourse.
4. Integrate principles of openness and a data-centred practice, leveraging skills in statistics, including Bayesian methods, and tools such as R, Git, Linux and Artificial Intelligence, to enhance the capabilities, efficiency and impact of teaching, research, service and leadership.
5. Contribute to governance through robust discussion and decision-making grounded in integrity, transparency and accountability.

EDUCATION

Doctor of Philosophy (PhD) 2018 to 2022

Australian National University - Research School of Population Health

Thesis - Women's brain health: disentangling the role of menopause and ageing

Master of Teaching (Secondary) Science Double Method Specialisation 2016 to 2017

University of New South Wales - School of Education

Diploma of Educational Studies 2013

College of Teachers, London

Bachelor of Science (Neuroscience) 2012 to 2015

University of New South Wales - School of Medical Science

CURRENT EMPLOYMENT

Lecturer 2021 to date

University of Canberra - Faculty of Health, Discipline of Psychology

PROFESSIONAL CREDENTIALS

Graduate of the Australian Institute of Company Directors (GAICD) 2026

Australian Institute of Company Directors

Senior Fellow (SFHEA) 2025

Advance HE

KEY RESEARCH AFFILIATIONS AND ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Research Affiliate	2025 to date
<i>University of Sydney - Faculty of Science, School of Psychology</i>	
Core Member	2024 to date
<i>Centre for Ageing Research and Translation (CARAT) - University of Canberra</i>	
Affiliated Research Fellow	2022 to date
<i>Femilab</i>	
Visiting Fellow	2022 to date
<i>Australian National University - Department of Health Economics Wellbeing and Society</i>	
Review Editor	2023 to date
<i>Frontiers in Aging Neuroscience - Alzheimer's Disease and Related Dementias</i>	

KEY LEADERSHIP AND GOVERNANCE ROLES

Academic Staff Representative on University Council	2026 to date
Committees:	
• Audit and Risk Management Committee Member	2026 to date
• Finance Committee Member	2026 to date
Working Groups:	
• Artificial Intelligence Advisory Working Group	2026 to date
<i>University of Canberra</i>	
Academic Staff Representative on Academic Board	2026 to date
<i>University of Canberra</i>	
Academic Staff Representative on Faculty Board	2025 to date
<i>University of Canberra - Faculty of Health</i>	
Chair of Faculty of Health Generative Artificial Intelligence Community of Practice	2023 to date
<i>University of Canberra - Faculty of Health</i>	

KEY PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT ROLES

Teacher and Developer - Software, Data and Library Carpentry	2020 to date
<i>The Carpentries</i>	
Podcast Presenter	2018 to date
<i>Midnight Conversations</i>	

PUBLICATIONS

My PhD was awarded and conferred on the 14th of July, 2022. As of 29th April, 2026, I have published 18 papers (10 first authored), which have been cited 911 times (H-index 11, Google Scholar), one of which with a FWCI of 6.76 (average 1.96, 25% of publications in top 10% most cited publications worldwide, 83.3% Q1, 100% Q1/Q2, from 2015 to 2024, SciVal).

1. **Ambikairajah, A.**, Foxe, D., de Lange, A. M. G., Carrick, J., Cheung, S. C., Srikanth, V. K., Hwang, Y. T., Ahmed, R. M., Burrell, J. R., & Piguet, O. (2025). A Bayesian analysis of diagnostic timelines across Alzheimer's disease, frontotemporal dementia, and other neurodegenerative conditions. *Alzheimer's & Dementia: Diagnosis, Assessment & Disease Monitoring*, 17, e70184. doi:10.1002/dad2.70184
2. Lawlis, N. H., Cherbuin, N., **Ambikairajah, A.**, Speer, H., D'Cunha, N. M., Rattray, B., & Northey, J. M. (2025). Objective physical activity in people with young onset dementia, late onset dementia, and without dementia: A UK Biobank study. *Journal of Alzheimer's disease* doi:10.1177/13872877251374261
3. Namsrai, T., Northey, J. M., **Ambikairajah, A.**, Ahmed, O., Alateeq, K., Oyarce, D. A. E., Burns, R., Rattray, B., & Cherbuin, N. (2025). Sleep characteristics and brain structure: A systematic review with meta-analysis. *Sleep Medicine*, 129, 316-329. doi:10.1016/j.sleep.2025.02.028
4. Isbel, S., D'Cunha, N. M., Wiseman, L., Dawda, P., Kosari, S., Pearce, C., Fearon, A., Sabeti, F., Hewitt, J., Kellett, J., Naunton, M., Southwood, H., Logan, P., Subramanian, R., Chadborn, N. H., Davey, R., Bail, K., Goss, J. R., **Ambikairajah, A.**, Lincoln, M., Holloway, H., & Gibson, D. (2025). Enhancing Allied Health Care for Older People in Residential Care: The EAHOP Intervention. *Healthcare*, 13(3), 341. doi:10.3390/healthcare13030341
5. Alateeq, K., Walsh, E.I., **Ambikairajah, A.**, & Cherbuin, N. (2024). Association between dietary magnesium intake, inflammation, and neurodegeneration. *European Journal of Nutrition*, 1-12 doi:10.1007/s00394-024-03383-1
6. **Ambikairajah, A.**, Khondoker, M., Morris, E., de Lange, A. M. G., Saleh, R. N. M., Minihane, A. M., & Hornberger, M. (2024). Investigating the synergistic effects of hormone replacement therapy, apolipoprotein E and age on brain health in the UK Biobank. *Human Brain Mapping*, 45(2), e26612. doi:10.1002/hbm.26612
7. Cherbuin, N., Patel, H., Walsh, E.I., **Ambikairajah, A.**, Burns, R., Brüstle, A., & Rasmussen, L.J. (2024). Cognitive Function Is Associated with the Genetically Determined Efficiency of DNA Repair Mechanisms. *Genes*, 15, 153. doi:10.3390/genes15020153
8. Schindler, L. S., Subramaniapillai, S., **Ambikairajah, A.**, Barth, C., Crestol, A., Voldsbekk, I., Beck, D., Gurholt, T. P., Topiwala, A., Suri, S., Ebmeier, K. P., Andreassen, O. A., Draganski, B., Westlye, L. T., & de Lange, A. M. G. (2023). Cardiometabolic health across menopausal years is linked to white matter hyperintensities up to a decade later. *Frontiers in Global Women's Health*, 4 doi:10.3389/fgwh.2023.1320640
9. Namsrai, T., **Ambikairajah, A.** & Cherbuin, N. (2023). Poorer sleep impairs brain health at midlife. *Scientific Reports*, 13(1), 1-10. doi:10.1038/s41598-023-27913-9
10. **Ambikairajah, A.**, Walsh, E.I., & Cherbuin, N. (2022). A review of menopause nomenclature. *Reproductive Health*, 19(1), 1-15. doi:10.1186/s12978-022-01336-7
11. **Ambikairajah, A.**, Tabatabaei-Jafari, H., Hornberger, M., & Cherbuin, N. (2021). Age, menstruation history, and the brain. *Menopause*, 28(2), 167-174. doi:10.1097/GME.0000000000001688
12. **Ambikairajah, A.**, Ambikairajah, R., & Ambikairajah, E. (2021). The impact of improving feelings of relatedness on motivation and engagement for tertiary students. *International Journal of Mathematical Education in Science and Technology*, 52(5), 721-730. doi:10.1080/0020739X.2019.1703149
13. **Ambikairajah, A.**, Tabatabaei-Jafari, H., Walsh, E., Hornberger, M., & Cherbuin, N. (2020). Longitudinal changes in fat mass and the hippocampus. *Obesity*, 28(7), 1263-1269. doi:10.1002/oby.22819
14. **Ambikairajah, A.**, Walsh, E., & Cherbuin, N. (2019). Lipid profile differences during menopause: a review with meta-analysis. *Menopause*, 26(11), 1327-1333. doi:10.1097/GME.0000000000001403
15. **Ambikairajah, A.**, Walsh, E., Tabatabaei-Jafari, H., & Cherbuin, N. (2019). Fat mass changes during menopause: a metaanalysis. *American Journal of Obstetrics & Gynecology*, 221(5), 393-409. doi:10.1016/j.ajog.2019.04.023

16. **Ambikairajah, A.,** & Tisdell, C. C. (2019). E-Examinations and the Student Experience Regarding Appropriateness of Assessment and Course Quality in Science and Medical Science. *Journal of Educational Technology Systems*, 47(4), 460-478. doi:10.1177/0047239518822016
17. Low, J. K., **Ambikairajah, A.,** Shang, K., Brown, D. A., Tsai, V. W., Breit, S. N., & Karl, T. (2017). First behavioural characterisation of a knockout mouse model for the transforming growth factor (TGF)- β superfamily cytokine, MIC-1/GDF15. *PLoS one*, 12(1), e0168416. doi:10.1371/journal.pone.0168416
18. **Ambikairajah, A.,** Devenney, E., Flanagan, E., Yew, B., Mioshi, E., Kiernan, M. C., Hodges, J. R., & Hornberger, M. (2014). A visual MRI atrophy rating scale for the amyotrophic lateral sclerosis-frontotemporal dementia continuum. *Amyotrophic Lateral Sclerosis and Frontotemporal Degeneration*, 15(3-4), 226-234. doi:10.3109/21678421.2014.880180

RESEARCH GRANTS AND AWARDS

I am the recipient of 4 competitive seed/project grant funding awards totalling \$19000, a research sabbatical fund totalling \$8078, an AGRTP scholarship totalling \$97937 and 2 other scholarships totalling \$2500. In addition, I have received 3 research presentation awards totalling \$1000, a highly commended award for outstanding new researcher and a commendation for outstanding early career researcher.

Teaching Innovation Generating Education Research (TIGER) Grant

2026

University of Canberra - Faculty of Health

I am co-chief investigator on a Faculty of Health TIGER grant (totalling \$3000) titled "Can we trust Artificial Intelligence (AI) to grade assessments? Evaluating Inter- and Intra-System Performance of Generative AI Platforms for Short-Answer Assessment Grading" Ambikairajah, A. & Murphy, T.

Commendation for Outstanding Early Career Researcher

2025

University of Canberra - Faculty of Health

Outside Studies Program

2025

University of Canberra

My application to undertake a research-focused Outside Studies Program (i.e., OSP) was successful, which included funds totalling \$8,078 to contribute towards OSP associated expenses. The two primary objectives of my OSP were to (1) establish a collaborative research program with FRONTIER at Brain and Mind Centre in the University of Sydney and (2) strengthen the development of my healthy ageing research program as part of the dementia stream within the Centre for Ageing Research and Translation (CARAT), via collaborations with the National Centre for Epidemiology and Population Health (NCEPH) at ANU. My OSP Seminar titled "[Stories and Statistics](#)" discusses the research I undertook during this period.

UC ReD IGNITE Program

2024 - 2025

University of Canberra

I was accepted for the highly competitive UC ReD IGNITE (University of Canberra Researcher Development: Instilling Growth and Nurturing Innovation through Training and Education) Program, which includes a \$10,000 research grant to support my research program, in addition to formal mentorship and research training.

Outstanding New Researcher Highly Commended Award

2024

Canberra Health Annual Research Meeting (CHARM)

I received the [Outstanding New Researcher Highly Commended Award](#) from the ACT Minister for Health. This was part of the CHARM Rising Star Awards which aimed to recognise and showcase the achievements of developing Canberra health researchers and contribute to a positive research culture which supports and acknowledges progress and development in research capacity and capability.

Rapid Fire Research Presentation Award

2024

University of Canberra - Faculty of Health

I was awarded \$500 (1st place) for my research presentation titled “Genetics, hormones and brain health, the curious case of the null result”.

Nomination for Early Career Researcher Award

2023

University of Canberra - Faculty of Health

I received a nomination for the Early Career Researcher Award, which is awarded to an individual early career researcher who has developed a purposeful and coherent research portfolio since their PhD and whose research has achieved impact. The award recognises individuals who have shown outstanding performance in research relative to opportunity.

Project Funds

2023 to 2024

University of Canberra - Faculty of Health

I was successful in receiving \$6,000 of funding from the Faculty of Health to cover the cost of a 1 year extension to access the UK Biobank dataset for the completion of an existing research project.

Best ERA 2023 Oral Presentation by a member of the Australian Association of Gerontology

2023

21st National Conference of Emerging Researchers in Ageing

I was awarded a prize to the value of \$250 and a certificate as my conference presentation was considered by the judging panel to be the best oral presentation by a member of the Australian Association of Gerontology at the 21st National Conference of Emerging Researchers in Ageing.

Rapid Fire Research Presentation Award

2023

University of Canberra - Faculty of Health

I was awarded \$250 (3rd place) for my research presentation titled “Genetics, hormones and brain health, the curious case of the null result”.

Complex Human Data Summer School Scholarship

2019

University of Melbourne

The Complex Human Data Summer School (CHDSS) Scholarship was a one off payment, valued at \$500, which covered the cost of travel and/or accomodation. Across 6 consecutive days, the CHDSS covered topics that included programming in R, reproducibility and open science, GitHub, bayesian data analysis, best practices for running online studies, experience sampling, probabilistic models of cognition, exploratory data analysis and generalised linear models.

Research to Impact Scholarship

2018

Canberra Innovation Network

The Research to Impact Scholarship was a one off payment, valued at \$2,000, which covered the cost of 4 half-day workshops that covered areas such as (1) innovation essentials and finding market need, (2) value propositions for big impact, (3) business models, value chain and collaboration and (4) pitching for outcomes and building your pitch-deck.

Australian Government Research Training Program Domestic Scholarship

2018 to 2021

Australian National University

The Australian Government Research Training Program (AGRTP) Domestic Scholarship was a fortnightly payment leading to a sum of \$83,946, over 3 years, with an additional \$13,991 top up for 6 months. The AGRTP Fee-Offset Scholarship covers the full tuition fees for 3 years.

TEACHING GRANTS AND AWARDS

I am the recipient of a Vice Chancellor's Excellence Award for Educator of the Year Award, a University Award for Teaching Excellence totalling \$2000 and a Student Nominated Award for Excellence in Teaching totalling \$1000. I have also received 2 commendations for Student Nominated Excellence in Teaching, a commendation for Excellence in Learning and Teaching and a Student Nomination for Excellence in Tutoring. I have also received a Team Award for Excellence in Learning and Teaching for Indigenising the Curriculum.

Vice Chancellor's Excellence Award for Educator of the Year 2025

University of Canberra

The Vice-Chancellor's Excellence Award for Educator of the Year is the highest university honour that recognises an exceptional individual for their outstanding contribution to learning and teaching.

UC Award for Teaching Excellence 2025

University of Canberra

The University of Canberra Award for Teaching Excellence recognises the work of an individual who has excelled in their teaching and who has made outstanding contributions to learning and teaching at the University of Canberra over a sustained period of at least three years.

Commendation for Excellence in Learning and Teaching (Individual) 2025

University of Canberra - Faculty of Health

Commendation for Excellence in Teaching - Student Award 2024

University of Canberra - Faculty of Health

Award for Excellence in Teaching - Student Award 2023

University of Canberra - Faculty of Health

I received an award for excellence in teaching, which was a student nominated award. This award included \$1000 and recognises individuals who have excelled in their teaching and who have made outstanding contributions to learning and teaching at the University of Canberra.

Commendation for Excellence in Teaching - Student Award 2022

University of Canberra - Faculty of Health

Excellence in Learning and Teaching Indigenising the Curriculum 2022

University of Canberra - Faculty of Health

As part of the Discipline of Psychology Team, I contributed to the Indigenisation of the Psychology Curriculum through collaboration with colleagues and Indigenous Australians via a series of yarning circles.

Nominated for the ANU Medical School Education Award for Excellence in Tutoring 2020

Australian National University

SERVICE TO UNIVERSITY

Academic Staff Representative on University Council 2026 to date

Elected by University of Canberra academic staff to represent their interests on the University Council, the University's governing body established under the University of Canberra Act 1989 (ACT). The Council oversees strategic direction, academic performance, financial management, risk, and policy. In this role, I contribute an academic perspective to decision-making while supporting the Council's statutory duty to act in the best interests of the University as a whole.

In this role, I serve on the Audit and Risk Management Committee which is responsible for advising Council on the University's control environment including audit, risk compliance and governance. I also serve on the Finance Committee, which advises Council on the University's financial performance, reporting and planning. I also serve on the Artificial Intelligence Advisory Working Group.

University of Canberra

Academic Staff Representative on Academic Board

2026 to date

As the Elected Academic Staff Representative on Council, I was appointed to Academic Board to represent academic staff interest. The University of Canberra Act 1989 (ACT) establishes the Academic Board which, subject to the Statutes, is responsible under the Council for all academic matters relating to the University; and may advise the Council on any matter relating to education, learning, research or the academic work of the University.

University of Canberra

Academic Staff Representative on Faculty of Health Board

2025 to date

Elected by University of Canberra Faculty of Health academic staff on Faculty Board, working within the Universities Regulations, policies and guidelines to achieve relevant, competitive and quality teaching and learning for its students. Additionally, the Faculty board is responsible for monitoring the impact and engagement, as well as other aspects, to ensure continuous improvement. Faculty Boards also play a crucial role in setting strategic academic and research directions for the Faculty and advising the Academic Board and the Vice-Chancellor on strategic institutional directions and on areas of concern.

University of Canberra - Faculty of Health

Low Risk Research Ethics Committee

2025 to date

In this role, I have reviewed 9 low risk ethics applications.

University of Canberra

Faculty of Health Digital Health Working Group

2024 to date

In this role, I am responsible for contributing my GenAI knowledge and expertise to the Digital Health Working Group, which is responsible for the development of several Faculty of Health microcredentials.

University of Canberra

Faculty of Health Representative for the Performance Expectations for Academic Staff (PEAS) Working Group

2024 to date

In this role, I am responsible for representing the Faculty of Health in the revision of the Performance Expectations for Academic Staff.

University of Canberra

Chair of Faculty of Health Generative Artificial Intelligence Community of Practice

2023 to date

In this role, I am responsible for leading the Faculty of Health in upskilling staff and students on GenAI to enhance their learning, teaching, research and professional practice, in addition to producing future ready graduates and tertiary educators. Some milestone achievements include:

- Established and grew the Community of Practice to over 50 staff members with collaborative partnerships across the higher education sector to share resources, knowledge and experiences via regular meetings (including formal seminars and informal coffee-catch ups) and workshops.
- Conducted faculty-wide surveys (2024: 71 respondents; 2025: 75 respondents) to assess GenAI usage, needs, and expertise, tracking changes over time.
- Developed and delivered multiple GenAI training workshops for 50+ academics across all levels and disciplines, resulting in the creation (2024) and subsequent update (2026) of a freely accessible online

version on [my website](#). These workshops were delivered across the University and also to high school educators in ACT.

- Engaged in consultancy work to develop and deliver multiple workshops for NSW Health Education and Training (HETI).
- Organised GenAI sessions at Faculty of Health Learning and Teaching symposium (2024 and 2025) and served as invited speaker at external institutions, including UTS GenAI ENHANCE Summit in 2025 and the Canberra Health Annual Research Meeting (2026).

University of Canberra - Faculty of Health

Manager of University of Canberra Chess Club on Chess.com 2023 to date

Chess.com

Faculty of Health Running Club 2023 to date

University of Canberra - Faculty of Health

Faculty of Health Education Committee 2023 to 2025

University of Canberra - Faculty of Health

Courses and Units Sub-Committee (CUSC) 2022 to 2023

University of Canberra - Faculty of Health

SERVICE TO RESEARCH

PEER REVIEW

I have peer reviewed 38 research articles (totalling 56 peer reviews). Of those, 9 reviews were for the British Medical Journal (BMJ - Q1, ranked 15/329 in general medicine) and 1 was for Neuroscience and Biobehavioural Reviews (Q1, ranked 3/115 in Cognitive Neuroscience). My peer review to publication ratio is 3.1:1 (Web of Science). I have also reviewed 24 honours theses since working as a Lecturer in 2021. I have also conducted an ethics review of a study protocol for the Government of South Australia Health and New South Wales Population and Health Services Research Ethics Committee.

Review Editor 2023 to date

Frontiers in Aging Neuroscience - Alzheimer's Disease and Related Dementias

Co-chair - Rapid Fire Research 2025

University of Canberra - Faculty of Health

Abstract Reviewer for CHARM 2025

I have peer reviewed 11 abstracts for the 2025 Canberra Health Annual Research Meeting (CHARM).

Canberra Health Annual Research Meeting (CHARM)

Judge - Rapid Fire Research 2024

Canberra Health Annual Research Meeting (CHARM)

Reviewer for Education Conference Support Funding 2024

University of Canberra - Faculty of Health

SERVICE TO COMMUNITY

Outreach and Public Engagement 2018 to date

I regularly engage with media and my research has been covered by major media outlets including [ABC news](#), [Nine news](#), [Sydney Morning Herald](#), [Australian Financial Review](#), The Australian and ABC Radio.

Links to all media outreach, including television, print, radio/podcast, in addition to invited talks, guest lectures and public speaking events can be found [here](#).

Teacher and Developer - Software, Data and Library Carpentry

2020 to date

The Carpentries

In this volunteer role, I am responsible for:

- Teaching R, shell, Git and software engineering skills to scientists and engineers at bootcamps and online sessions.
- Developing new instructional content.
- Developing and maintaining The Carpentries GitHub repositories.

Podcast Presenter

2018 to date

Midnight Conversations

Midnight Conversations is a podcast that discusses published, peer-reviewed scientific papers in an understandable and engaging way. The primary aim of the podcast is to foster a public interest in current scientific research to promote public engagement and provide a forum for critical and productive scientific discourse. As of 29th April, 2026, Midnight Conversations has 65 episodes which have accrued 9914 plays.

CONFERENCE ORAL PRESENTATIONS

INTERNATIONAL

1. Namsrai T., Burns R., **Ambikairajah A.**, Northey J.M., Rattray B., Cherbuin N. (2026). Stability Of Sleep Quality And Its Association With Cognitive Function Across The Lifespan. Oral presentation accepted for the 37th Global Conference of Alzheimer's Disease International, Lyon, France.
2. **Ambikairajah A.**, Tisdell C. (2020). Algorithms and software - Using Maple in humanities related assessment: Exploring beyond mathematical boundaries in education. Presentation accepted for the *Maple Conference*, Online.
3. **Ambikairajah A.**, Tisdell C. (2018). The Effects of E-Examinations on Student Satisfaction Regarding Appropriateness of Assessment and Course Quality in Science and Medical Science. Presentation accepted for the *International Mobile Learning Festival*, Mobile Learning, STEM and Transdisciplinary Education, Singapore.

NATIONAL

1. Ovington L., **Ambikairajah A.**, Shannon K., Smyth A., Bail K. (2026). Examining associations between nursing skill mix and patient outcomes in rural hospitals. Oral presentation accepted for the 18th National Rural Health Conference, Adelaide
2. Namsrai T., Burns R., **Ambikairajah A.**, Northey J.M., Rattray B., Cherbuin N. (2026). Stability Of Sleep Quality And Its Association With Cognitive Function Across The Lifespan. Presentation accepted for the AAIC Neuroscience Next, Sydney, Australia
3. **Ambikairajah A.** (2025). Faculty of Health Generative Artificial Intelligence Community of Practice: Reflections and the Road Ahead. Invited speaker for the Faculty of Health Learning and Teaching Symposium, University of Canberra.
4. Ghiasvand S., Bagheri N., **Ambikairajah A.**, Tabatabaei-Jafari, H., Soumya M., Salvador-Carulla, L. (2025). Social & Environmental Determinants of Dementia Risk. Presentation accepted for the *Canberra Health Annual Research Meeting (CHARM)*, University of Canberra
5. Pike A., Cherbuin N., **Ambikairajah A.**, Lawlis N., Rattray B., Northey J. (2025). Physical activity intensities, cognitive function and brain volumes in men with and without prostate cancer. Presentation accepted for the *Canberra Health Annual Research Meeting (CHARM)*, University of Canberra

6. **Ambikairajah A.** (2025). Generative Artificial Intelligence at University of Canberra, Faculty of Health Community of Practice. Invited speaker for the *GenAI-ENHANCE UTS Faculty of Health Summit*, University of Technology Sydney, Sydney, Australia.
7. Lawlis N., Cherbuin N., **Ambikairajah A.**, Speer H., D'Cunha N., Rattray B., Northey J. (2024). Comparisons of objective physical activity behaviour among people with younger and late-onset dementia: A cross-sectional analysis of the UK Biobank. Presentation accepted for the *International Congress on Neuropsychiatry*, Melbourne, Australia.
8. **Ambikairajah A.**, Khondoker M., Morris E., de Lange A., Saleh R., Minihane A., Hornberger M. (2024). Investigating the Synergistic Effects of Hormone Replacement Therapy, APOE and Age on Brain Health. Presentation accepted for the *Canberra Health Annual Research Meeting (CHARM)*, ACT Government.
9. **Ambikairajah A.** (2024). Faculty of Health Generative Artificial Intelligence: Exploring usage, needs and expertise. Invited speaker for the *Faculty of Health Learning and Teaching Symposium*, University of Canberra.
10. **Ambikairajah A.**, Khondoker M., Morris E., de Lange A., Saleh R., Minihane A., Hornberger M. (2023). Investigating the Synergistic Effects of Hormone Replacement Therapy, APOE and Age on Brain Health. Presentation accepted for the *21st National Conference of Emerging Researchers in Ageing*, Online.
11. **Ambikairajah A.** (2023). Genetics, hormones and brain health - the curious case of the null result. Ask the ERA Brains Trust Presentation accepted for the *21st National Conference of Emerging Researchers in Ageing*, Online.
12. **Ambikairajah A.** (2018). Being Courageous: Exploring new approaches to improve and expand learning experiences - A Practical Framework for Courageousness in Teaching. Presentation accepted for the *Learning and Teaching Forum, Partners in Learning: Connecting Communities*, University of New South Wales, Australia.
13. **Ambikairajah A.** (2018). Being Courageous: Exploring new approaches to improve and expand learning experiences - A Practical Framework for Courageousness in Teaching. Presentation accepted for the *Learning and Teaching Forum, Partners in Learning: Connecting Communities*, University of New South Wales, Australia.
14. **Ambikairajah A.** (2017). Inspired Learning by Inspired Teaching - Quality student relationships can predict excellence in leaning and teaching. Presentation accepted for the *Learning and Teaching Forum, Educational Excellence: Transforming Futures*, University of New South Wales, Australia.

CONFERENCE ABSTRACT AND POSTER PUBLICATIONS

INTERNATIONAL

1. Schindler L., Subramaniapillai S., **Ambikairajah A.**, Barth C., Voldsbekk I., Beck D., Gurholt T., Topiwala A., Suri S., Ebmeier K., Draganski B., Andreassen O., Westlye L., de Lange A. (2023). Body Composition Changes Across The Menopause Transition And Their Association With White Matter Hyperintensities: A Longitudinal Study. Abstract and poster accepted for the *48th Annual Conference Psychologie & Gehirn*, University of Tübingen, Germany.
2. Cherbuin N., Namsrai T., **Ambikairajah A.** (2022). Good sleep, healthy brain, and sharp mind all dream together. Abstract and poster accepted for the *28th Annual Meeting of the Organisation for Human Brain Mapping*, OHBM, Scotland.

NATIONAL

1. **Ambikairajah A.**, Foxe D., de Lange A., Subramaniapillai S., D'Cunha N.M., Longo S., Carrick J., Cheung S.C., Srikanth Y.K., Hwange Y.T., Ahmed R.M., Burrell J.R., Piguet O. (2026). Symptom onset uncertainty as a source of bias in neurodegenerative research. Abstract and poster accepted for the *Australia Dementia Research Forum 2026*, Sydney, Australia.

2. Ghiasvand S., Tegegne G., Tabatabaei-Jafari H., Mazumdar S., **Ambikairajah A.**, Bagheri N. (2026). Social and Environmental Determinants of Dementia Risk: An Umbrella Review. Abstract and poster accepted for the *Australia Dementia Research Forum 2026*, Sydney, Australia.
3. Namsrai T., Burns R., **Ambikairajah A.**, Northey J.M., Rattray B., Cherbuin N. (2026). Stability Of Sleep Quality And Its Association With Cognitive Function Across The Lifespan. Abstract and poster accepted for the *Australia Dementia Research Forum 2026*, Sydney, Australia.
4. Namsrai T., Burns R., **Ambikairajah A.**, Northey J.M., Rattray B., Cherbuin N. (2025). Stability Of Sleep Quality And Its Association With Cognitive Function Across The Lifespan. Abstract and poster accepted for the *Canberra Health Annual Research Meeting (CHARM)*, ACT Government
5. Namsrai T., **Ambikairajah A.**, Burns R., Northey J., Rattray B., Cherbuin N. (2024). Impact of Poor Sleep on Cognition Through the Years in Young, Middle, and Older Adults. Abstract and poster accepted for the *The 57th Australian Association of Gerontology Conference*, Tasmania, Australia.
6. Isbel S., Gibson D., D'Cunha N., Dawda P., Kosari S., Pearce C., Fearon A., Sabeti F., Hewitt J., Kellett J., Naunton M., Southwood H., Logan P., Subramanian R., Chadborn N., Davey R., Bail K., Goss J., **Ambikairajah A.**, Lincoln M., Wiseman L. (2024). The Enhanced Allied health for Older people in residential care (EAHOP RC) Trial. Abstract and poster accepted for the Australian Association of Gerontology *The 57th Australian Association of Gerontology Conference*, Tasmania, Australia.
7. Pike A., Cherbuin N., **Ambikairajah A.**, Lawlis N., Rattray B., Northey J. (2024). Physical activity intensities, cognition and brain volumes in men with prostate cancer. Abstract and poster accepted for the *Clinical Oncology of Australia Annual Scientific Meeting*, Queensland, Australia
8. **Ambikairajah A.**, Tisdell C. (2016). Changing how we think about teaching - A reflection of the Pilot Active Learning Spaces (PALS) initiative. Abstract accepted for the *Learning and Teaching Forum, Towards 2025: Inspiring Learning*, University of New South Wales, Sydney, Australia.

STUDENT SUPERVISION

PHD

- | | |
|---------------------------------------|--------------|
| 1. [REDACTED] - Advisor | 2026 to date |
| <i>University of Canberra</i> | |
| 2. [REDACTED] - Secondary supervisor | 2025 to date |
| <i>University of Canberra</i> | |
| 3. [REDACTED] - Secondary supervisor | 2025 to date |
| <i>University of Canberra</i> | |
| 4. [REDACTED] - Associate supervisor | 2022 to date |
| <i>Australian National University</i> | |

MASTERS

- | | |
|--|------|
| 1. [REDACTED] - Co-supervisor | 2020 |
| <i>Australian National University</i> | |
| Thesis mark: 80; Final Grade Point Average: 6.69 (Distinction) | |

HONOURS

- | | |
|------------------------------------|------|
| 1. [REDACTED] - Primary supervisor | 2026 |
| <i>University of Canberra</i> | |
| 2. [REDACTED] - Primary supervisor | 2026 |

- University of Canberra*
3. [REDACTED] - Primary supervisor 2026
- University of Canberra*
4. [REDACTED] - Primary supervisor 2026
- University of Canberra*
5. [REDACTED] - Primary supervisor 2024
- University of Canberra*
- Thesis Mark: 82; Final grade: 79 (Distinction Honours IIa)
6. [REDACTED] - Primary supervisor 2024
- University of Canberra*
- Thesis Mark: 79; Final grade: 79 (Distinction Honours IIa)
7. [REDACTED] - Primary supervisor 2024
- University of Canberra*
- Thesis Mark: 83; Final grade: 82 (Distinction Honours IIa)
8. [REDACTED] - Primary supervisor 2024
- University of Canberra*
- Thesis Mark: 70; Final grade: 70 (Credit Honours IIb)
9. [REDACTED] - Primary supervisor 2023
- University of Canberra*
- Thesis Mark: 91; Final grade: 91 (High Distinction Honours I)
10. [REDACTED] - Primary supervisor 2023
- University of Canberra*
- Thesis Mark: 78; Final grade: 78 (Distinction Honours IIa)
11. [REDACTED] - Primary supervisor 2022
- University of Canberra*
- Thesis Mark: 88; Final grade: 90 (High Distinction Honours I)
- 2022 Australian Psychological Society Prize Winner
12. [REDACTED] - Primary supervisor 2022
- University of Canberra*
- Thesis Mark: 72; Final grade: 78 (Distinction Honours IIa)
13. [REDACTED] - Primary supervisor 2022
- University of Canberra*
- Thesis Mark: 70; Final grade: 73 (Credit Honours IIb)

ACCREDITATION/PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Company Directors Course 2025 to 2026

Australian Institute of Company Directors

UC Management Essentials Program 2024

University of Canberra

Working with Vulnerable People - General Registration 2023 to 2028

ACT

Higher Degree Research Supervisor 2022 to date

University of Canberra

MENTORSHIP

Higher Education Academy Mentoring Program 2025 to date

University of Canberra

In this program, I am a mentor for colleagues pursuing fellowship with the Higher Education Academy. Currently I am mentoring [REDACTED] and [REDACTED].

Canberra Health Services Research Mentoring Program 2024

Canberra Health Services

In this program, I mentored [REDACTED]. The mentorship program aims to support development of Canberra Health Services (CHS) staff to (1) increase research capability and activity, (2) develop networks in CHS and across the Australian Capital Territory and (3) improve career progression, confidence and satisfaction.

Big Brother Scholarship Mentor 2018 - 2021

Ananthan Ambikairajah

MENTEESHIP

Teaching Excellence Mentoring Program 2024

In this program, I was mentored by Professor Nick Ball. The mentorship focuses on my application for the University of Canberra Teaching Excellence Award.

University of Canberra - Faculty of Health

Higher Education Academy Mentoring Program 2023 to 2025

University of Canberra

In this program, I was mentored by Adjunct Professorial Associate Peter Copelan. The mentorship focused primarily on my Fellowship and Senior Fellowship application submissions to the Higher Education Academy.

Faculty of Health Mentoring Program 2021 to present

In this program, I was mentored by Professor Douglas Boer and am currently mentored by Associate Professor Phillip Newman. The mentorship focuses on my university portfolio (i.e. research, teaching, service and engagement), in addition to opportunities for professional development and pathways for promotion.

University of Canberra - Faculty of Health

FUNDRAISING AND OTHER INTERESTS

Running

2020 to date

- Canberra Times Marathon 2024, 2025, 2026
- Sydney Marathon 2024, 2025
- Stromlo Marathon 2025
- Indigenous Marathon Reconciliation Week Fun Run (10km) 2022 to 2023
- Dementia Australia Memory Walk and Jog (10km) 2020, 2023 to date

Total Funds Raised for Dementia Australia via Running = \$1095

Rock Climbing

2020 to 2024

Performing Stand-up Comedian

2013 to 2018

Bamboo Flautist

2001 to 2016

Chess

2002 to date

Tennis

1999 to date